

Industry News

Worldwide semiconductor revenue grows 31 per cent

Total worldwide semiconductor revenue reached \$299.4 billion in 2010—up by 30.9 per cent from 2009. The top 25 semiconductor suppliers accounted for 69.1 per cent of the revenue and, as a group, memory vendors showed the strongest growth.

“The industry-wide upturn was due to the combination of pent-up demand that had built in the wake of the worldwide economic recession, and rebuilding of semiconductor inventories that were significantly depleted during the recession and early recovery,” said Peter Middleton, principal analyst, market research firm Gartner.

“The market began to surge in the second half of 2009, as demand recovery in a variety of market sectors resulted in strong order rates. This continued, almost frantically, during the first half of 2010 as demand soared, prices rose, and we saw lead times expanding significantly,” he added.

Tablets to drive IT spending up

Gartner expects the worldwide IT spending to total \$3600 billion in 2011—a 5.6 per cent increase from \$3400 billion in 2010. Adding media tablets, such as the iPad, to its computing hardware spending estimates has increased the computing hardware growth outlook from 7.5 per cent to 9.5 per cent for 2011.

Global spending on media tablets is projected to reach \$29.4 billion in 2011—up from \$9.6 billion in 2010—and increase at a rate of 52 per cent annually through 2015.

Apple iPad will dominate the tablet market till 2015, though its market share would shrink from 90

Pramanik is Microsoft India chairman

Former Oracle India chief Bhaskar Pramanik has been appointed as the new chairman of Microsoft India. He will oversee the company's sales, marketing and services subsidiary and also provide overall leadership on all Microsoft assets in India.

Fifty-five-year-old Pramanik will report to Jean-Philippe Courtois, president of Microsoft International.

Dell India appoints new chairman

Dell India has appointed Suresh Vaswani as the new chairman and chief of applications and business process outsourcing (BPO) organisation of Dell Services.

The former Wipro CEO will focus on building next-generation service offering and growing its process capabilities on

a global basis across multiple industry verticals and market segments.

“The role of chairman India is to leverage the potential of India for enhancing Dell's services strength globally. India is also a fairly significant market for Dell, so I have to make sure that it is one of the top technology and solutions companies in India,” said Vaswani.

CommScope appoints new head of wireless sales

CommScope, an infrastructure solutions provider for communication networks, has appointed Pankaj Gandhi as director of wireless sales for India. In this role, Gandhi will head all customer-facing sales activities for CommScope's wireless business in India. He will report to Navin Vohra, who was promoted to the position of vice president-wireless sales, Asia Pacific, last year.

per cent plus today to 47 per cent with the emergence of plethora of players.

Android will continue to increase its influence and would grab 38 per cent of the market share. Also, Play-Book's QNX OS would claim 10 per

cent, while MeeGo, WebOS and others will be limited to a small share of 1-3 per cent.

Despite mounting competition from other operating systems (OS), Apple's iOS will continue to own the majority of the worldwide media tablets market through 2015. Due to



Apple iPad

